The impact of the Missionary Clause of the 1813 Act was the initiation of the evangelical project of ‘reforming’ Bharat, for which Buchanan’s and other missionaries’ work demonising Bharat, its faith systems, traditions and society in general, had laid the foundation.[31] The Bengal Sati Regulation of 1829 was a direct product of the movement for ‘social reform’. In fact, Dr. Meenakshi Jain in her scholarly work *Sati: Evangelicals, Baptist Missionaries, and the Changing Colonial Discourse*[32] has brilliantly captured the direct nexus between the said law and the malicious representation of Hindu society using Sati as the soapbox to grandstand from in order to legitimise the civilising mission of the Christian White European coloniser. She demonstrates credibly in her book that the presence of Sati as a practice was nowhere close to being as rampant as it was made out to be by the missionaries to ‘shock and motivate the British public and also garner funds at home for missionary work in India’, apart from pushing for the inclusion of the Missionary Clause in the 1813 Act.

She underscores the fact that it could not have been a matter of mere coincidence that all the ‘ills’ of the Hindu society were to be found in the vicinity of Calcutta or in Bengal, which was the seat of British power and also that of the Bishop in India at the time. Jain rightly argues that it was possible for Sati to be addressed without demonising Hindus and Hinduism —as evidenced by the approach of the Tagore family[33]—and yet the goal of the missionaries in using Sati as the springboard for their attacks on the faith of the Indic heathen could not have been more obvious. I leave it to the reader to ask themselves whether the approach of the missionaries in the 1800s towards Hindu society, its faith, culture and institutions is mirrored in contemporary representations of Hindus and Hinduism, both *by Hindus themselves and others*. If the answer is in the affirmative, would it not be reasonable to conclude that this is due to ingrained coloniality and colonialised versions of Bharat’s worldview by successive generations of ‘natives’?

The next landmark legislation whose provisions as well as the surrounding legislative debates leave nothing to the imagination with respect to the evangelising nature of British colonisation is the Government of India Act of 1833 passed in August 1833, also known as the Charter Act of 1833.[34] This legislation officially cemented Britain’s colonisation of Bharat as indicated by the following observations: